

5. Coolgardie lies in the Australian province of –
 (a) New South Wales (b) Northern Territory
 (c) Queensland (d) Western Australia

U.P.P.C.S (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

6. Johannesburg is famous for –
 (a) Gold mining (b) Tin mining
 (c) Mica mining (d) Iron-ore mining

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Johannesburg is the largest city of South Africa and the capital of Gauteng Province. It is famous for its gold and diamond mining.

7. Which of the following countries is the largest exporter of gold to India ?
 (a) Brazil (b) UAE
 (c) Switzerland (d) South Africa

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (c)

Switzerland is the largest gold exporting country to India in the year when the question was asked. According to Indian Minerals Yearbook, 2022 Hong Kong is the largest exporting country in 2021-22 (P) of gold.

8. Asia's biggest gold market is :
 (a) Jakarta, Indonesia (b) Beijing, China
 (c) Kathmandu, Nepal (d) Meerut, India

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (b)

When this question was asked option (b) was the correct answer. As of February 2025, the Shanghai Gold Exchange (SGE) in China stands as the largest gold market in Asia.

v. The Silver

Silver is the second most precious metal after gold and is used for making of ornaments, coins, electroplating, photography and medicinal purposes. It is found in free elemental form in nature in metamorphic rocks. *According to figures from the USGS Mineral Commodity Summaries, 2025. The top four countries with the largest silver reserves are–Peru (140000 tonnes), Australia (94,000 tonnes), Russia (92000 tonnes), China (70000 tonnes) Poland (61000 tonnes). * According to

World Mineral Production, 2018-22. The top five countries in terms of silver (metal content) production (2022) are– Mexico, China, Peru, Poland and Russia. *German silver is also known as, nickel silver, paktong, new silver, alpacca, etc. It is an alloy comprised of **60% copper, 20% zinc and 20% nickel** (However according to NCERT the composition of German silver is Cu (25-30%), Zn (25-30%) and Ni (40-50%). Hence, the alloy does not contain any silver. Since it shines like silver it was given the name German silver.

1. The largest producer of Silver in the world is:

- (a) Chile (b) China
 (c) Mexico (d) Peru

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (c)

According to World Mineral Production, 2018-22 the five largest producers of silver in the world (2022) are -

(Country)	(In kilograms of metal content)
Mexico	- 7067580
China	- 3477400
Peru	- 3080000
Poland	- 1533000
Russia	- 1300000

2. Mexico is the largest producer of :

- (a) Gold (b) Copper
 (c) Zinc (d) Silver

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (d)

According to data from World Mineral Production 2018-22, in the year 2022, Mexico is the largest producer of silver.

3. Which one of the following does not contain silver ?

- (a) Horn Silver
 (b) German Silver
 (c) Ruby Silver
 (d) Lunar Caustic

I.A.S. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (b)

German silver is also known as nickel silver, Maillechort, new silver, Alpacca, etc. It is a copper alloy with nickel and often zinc. The usual formulation is 60% copper, 20% nickel and 20% zinc (but according to NCERT the composition of german silver is Cu (25-30%), Zn (25-30%) and Ni (40-50%). It is named for its silvery appearance but it contains no silver element.